met in Delhi and spent some time with each other. Since then, Carolyn has travelled to India quite regularly. She made it a point to visit Mumbai on Ratan's eightieth birthday on 28 December 2017 and visited him again in 2021. Ratan also takes Carolyn out for dinner almost every time he is in the US.

Homecoming

In August 1962, when Ratan returned to India, much had changed at Tata House. His father had remarried and had a five-year-old son, Noel. It was not that Ratan was taken by surprise. In 1955 when Ratan was on a visit to Bombay for his holidays, Naval Tata had confided to him that he intended to marry Simone Dunoyer. Naval often travelled to Geneva as the president of the Employers' Federation of India, which made him a delegate to the ILO headquartered in the Swiss capital. He had met Simone on one of these trips. Naval had introduced her to Ratan when the latter had stopped over in Switzerland to meet his father. Before their marriage, Simone had also visited Bombay and Ratan had showed her around the city.

Ratan spent virtually all the time he could get with his grandmother until she passed away in 1965. Ratan recalls: 'We were very close and spent a lot of time together. It would be in the multiples of time I spent with my father. We spent hours together when I grew up and came on holiday from college because she was by this time quite old and frail.'

He was hopeful that in India, he would have the freedom to decide his future, where he would stay and the company he would work with. That, however, was not to be. J.R.D. Tata, the legendary chairman of Tata Sons and the patriarch of the family, had other views.

Jehangir Ratanji Dadabhoy Tata, popularly known as JRD, was born in Paris in 1904 to Ratanji Dadabhoy Tata and Suzanne (Sooni) Briere. He was the grandson of Dadabhoy Kavasji Tata, Jamsetji Tata's wife's brother. JRD was a man of myriad qualities and talents. Starting as an assistant with Tata Sons in 1922, he was appointed as one of its directors four years later, upon the death of his father. He became its chairman after about a decade and two years since. Under JRD's chairmanship, which spanned nearly fifty-three years from 1938 to 1991, the group grew from a fourteen-company conglomerate to a ninety-five-enterprise behemoth. The companies that were started under his watch include Tata Chemicals, Tata